



Reimagining the dating mechanism with a new feature

Market Snapshot

MAU	Paying users	Liquidity time	ARPPU
80 – 100 M	5% – 15%	24-72hrs for males	18\$

Business model



messaging
and matching



Omegle style
matching



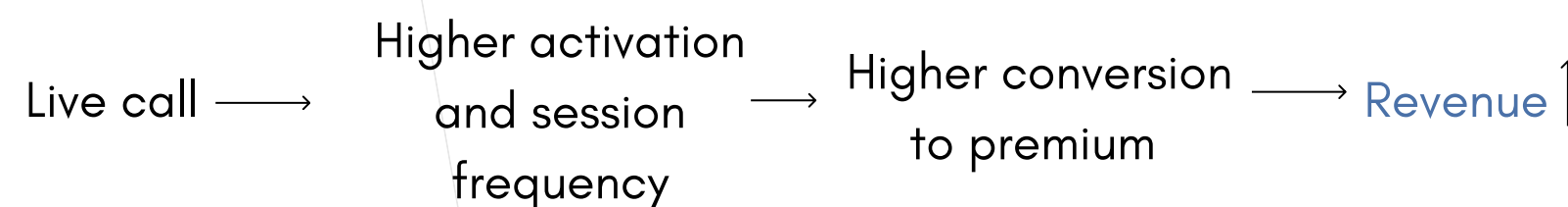
Premium/Freemium

How does the Sonder tab align with Hinge's Existing business

We already have profile-based matching (Bumble App), calling infrastructure (Video/Voice), and a subscription paywall. Sonder reuses all three, it's a new discovery surface built entirely on infrastructure Bumble already owns.

Why should these businesses care?

Bumble is in a retention and differentiation crisis, not a growth stage — paying users fell 16% YoY and revenue fell ~9% YoY (Q3 2025 vs Q3 2024). It needs a new engagement lever, not just marginal algorithm tweaks.



$$\text{Revenue} = \text{Avg Revenue Per User (ARPU)} * \text{\#Users}$$
$$\text{ARPU} = \text{Avg order value/user} * \text{Avg frequency of orders}$$

Product Discovery

Goal: Let users judge real chemistry through voice/video before investing days into texting a stranger who may not be who they seem.

What is “real chemistry”?

"Everything on my summary and matches these days is a full risk. I've decided I'll write for a week to someone who turns out to have a totally different personality than their profile suggested."

- **Harsh**, 22 years, Goa

Perception: Generally understood as: hearing someone's tone, humor, and reactions live the things a profile and 6 texts can't convey. It's the digital version of the "does this feel real" gut-check people rely on in person

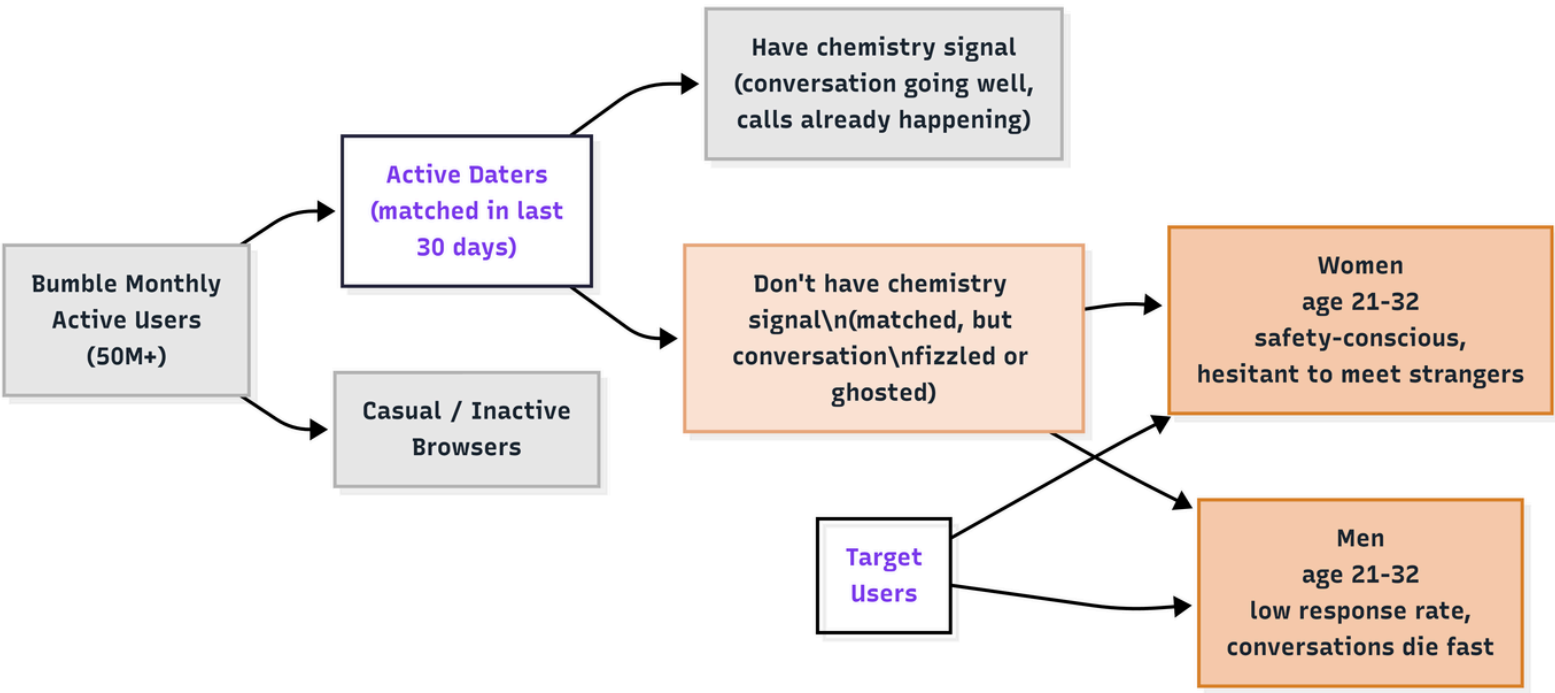
Why does this matter?

Text-based matching creates a verification and effort gap — users sink days into conversation before learning whether there's any real chemistry, and separately, before confirming the person is even who their profile claims. Both problems compound into "dating app fatigue," the single most cited reason for app abandonment across the category.

Actors in the System

- Callers — verified users opting into **Sonder** for faster discovery
- Matching Algorithm — **queues** and **pairs** users by stated interests/preferences
- Safety & Verification Layer — ID check + pre-call AI scan + in-call monitoring
- Platform — hosts identity, matching, calling, and payment infrastructure

Know our Users!



note:Note: Tier percentages are illustrative estimates based on category-wide dating app behavior patterns, not Company-specific data – validate with a targeted survey or pilot cohort before using in an investor-facing deck.

How big is the market?

50M MAU x 60% active daters x 45% experienced fizzled matches x 35% willing to try a new discovery mode ≈ 4.7M users

What are their problems?

- **78%** : Users who report feeling emotionally, mentally, or physically exhausted by dating apps at least sometimes (Forbes Health/OnePoll, 2024)
- **71% of men / 47% of women** : Frequently encounter fake or misleading profiles on dating apps (YouGov/Statista, 2023)
- **45%** : Admit to having ghosted (abandoned) a match themselves after a conversation stalled (DatingAdvice.com survey compilation)

Consolidated Problems

- No fast way to verify authenticity or "real vibe"
- Text-based discovery is high-effort and slow
- Existing calling are locked an committed match, too late to help

CURRENT	DESCRIPTION	MISSING
Bumble/Tinder	Video call <i>after</i> match	No discovery-stage calling
Hinge	Intentional prompts	Removed video calling entirely
Omegle (dead, 2023)	Random video chat	No matching algorithm, 0 safety



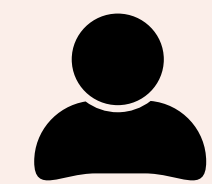
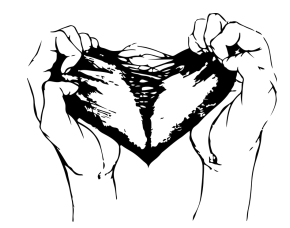
User Persona



26 yrs | Marketing Manager | Bangalore
New to the city, dating cautiously after a bad experience
Screens every profile carefully before replying,

Pain-Points Struggles to tell if a profile is even real before engaging
Feels on-guard by default when talking to new matches

Needs A way to verify someone is real before investing time
A lower-risk way to screen out bad actors earlier



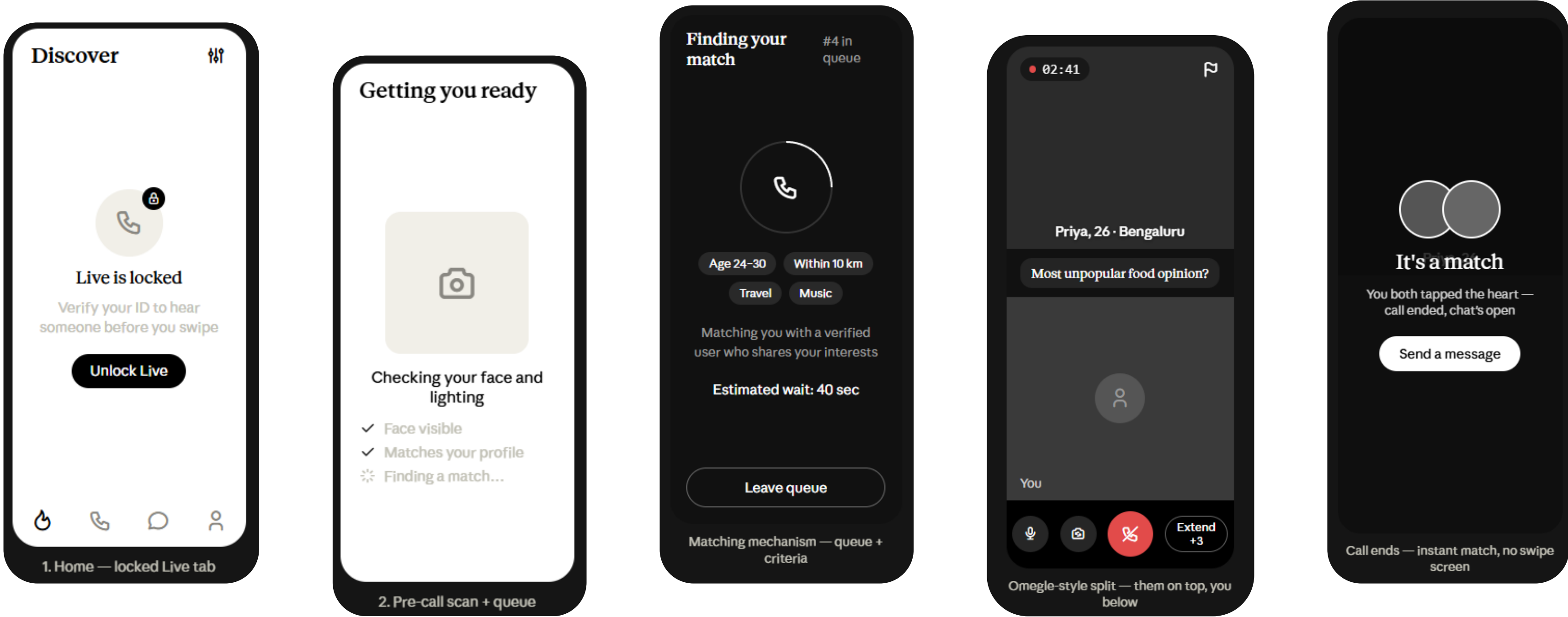
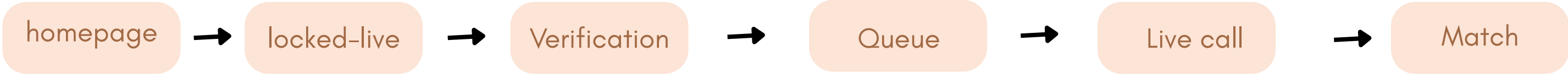
27 yrs | Investment Banker | Mumbai
Recently out of a long relationship | Swipes during commute
Sends plenty of opening messages, rarely gets a reply

Pain-Points Feels like he's shouting into a void , most swipes go nowhere
Rarely gets a reply even when he does match

Needs A way to show personality beyond a static profile/opening text
A way to feel less exposed to constant rejection

User Persona

How does our product look like? User side experience



"Lock badge creates FOMO before users even open the tab"
"One-line CTA, no explanation needed — curiosity does the work"

- "Camera check runs silently in the background"*
- "Checklist builds trust before the call even starts"*

Additional features that aren't mentioned here

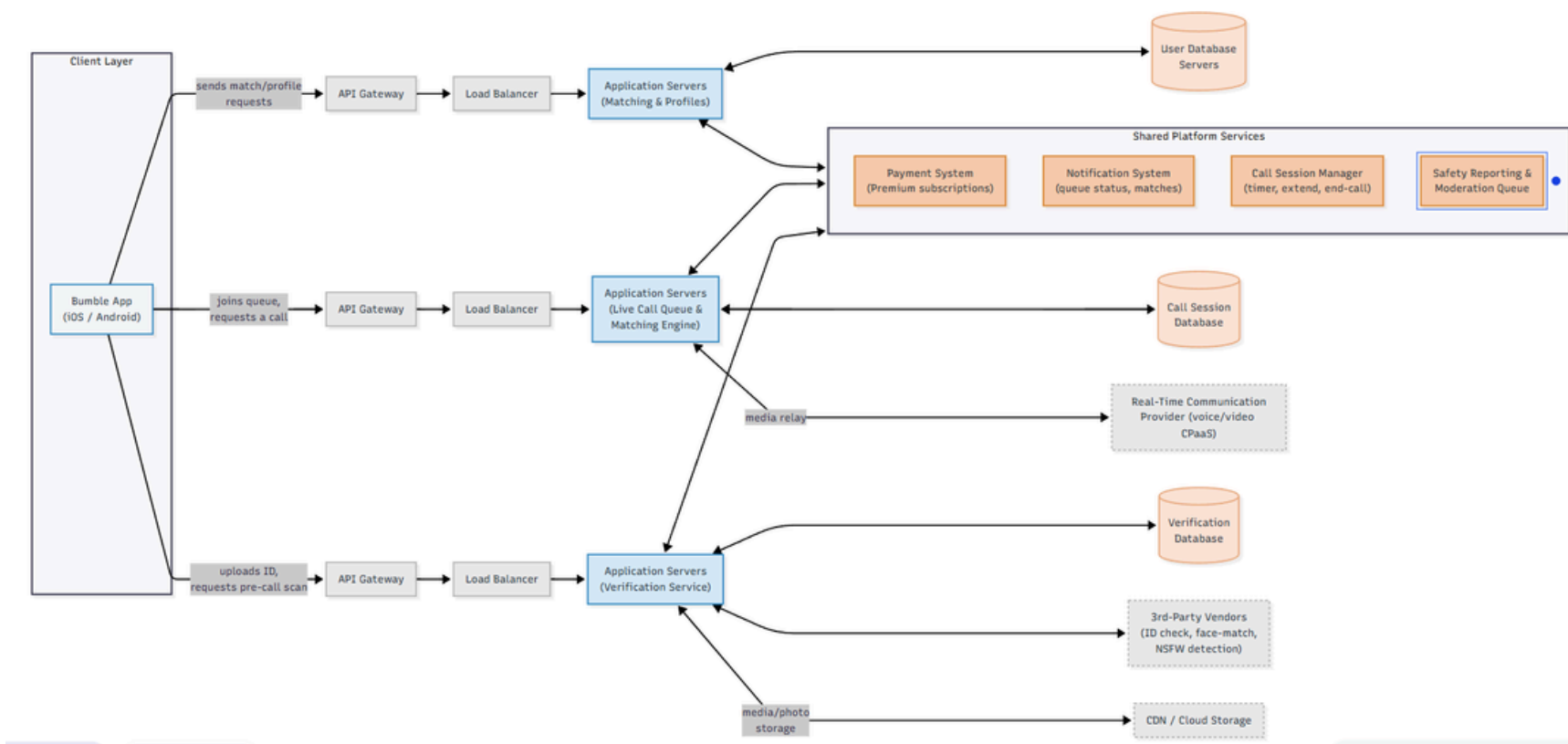
- Customer support to raise concerns
- Dedicated place to see all active subscriptions
- Manage subscriptions (Cancel- in MVP, Pause - Post MVP, Skip - Post MVP)

Check User App Prototype

What are the risks & how do we deal with them?

RISK	MITIGATION
Cold start — empty queue at odd hours	Launch single-metro; schedule "Live Hours" events to concentrate demand
Call anxiety limits adoption	Voice-only in v1 (not video); 3-min timer keeps commitment low
Safety incident during a call	3-layer system: ID verification + pre-call AI scan + in-call monitoring/report
Gender imbalance in queue	Priority queue for women; show live queue stats transparently
Feature cannibalizes Traditional Tab engagement	Frame as an alternate discovery mode, not a replacement — Traditional Tab remains default

System Design



What each piece does?

Matching & Profiles service
Live Call Queue & Matching Engine

Verification Service
Shared Platform Services

RTC Provider

What are the second order effects of this product?

- Cannibalization risk:** Could reduce time spent in the Traditional Tab if users self-select into Live only — monitor total session time, not just Call Tab adoption,
- New user base:** Could attract call-anxious-but-safety-conscious users who previously avoided dating apps altogether, expanding Bumble's addressable market
- Category shift:** If successful, could push Hinge/Tinder to re-enter live-call discovery, turning this into a new expected feature category-wide first